Field page, Level 1

You hold the rules. The headset player (Site) sees the job; the planner (Plan) can hold or start crews. You see neither. When Site describes something, find it below and say what it is and how long it lasts. When one crew is gaining on another, work out when it will catch up.

The job

3,000 ft of pipe. Stakes every 100 ft: "five plus twenty" (5+20) is 520 ft from the start.

Crew	Foreman	Speed	Along the trench
Excavation	Ray	220 ft a day	first
Pipe	Marcus	180 ft a day	second
Backfill	Dana	250 ft a day	third

A crew never passes the crew in front of it.

What Site might describe

If Site says something like	It is	What happens
A wall has fallen into the trench, water in the bottom, the pipe crew climbed out	A trench collapse	Pipe laying stops for 2 days while the wall is cleared, then starts again by itself
Two foremen arguing	The crew behind has caught the crew in front	Both crews stop until the crew behind is held
A crew standing around	It is held, or it is waiting for the crew in front	Every day a crew stands on site is an idle crew-day

A crew that has not started yet is not on site: holding it only delays its start.

Catching up

A faster crew behind a slower one closes the gap every day.

Days until it catches up = the gap in feet ÷ how many feet a day the gap closes.

The crew behind	The crew in front	The gap closes by
Backfill (250)	Pipe, working (180)	70 ft a day
Backfill (250)	Pipe, stopped	250 ft a day
Pipe (180)	Excavation, working (220)	never; pipe falls further behind

Example: backfill 300 ft behind a stopped pipe crew catches it in 300 ÷ 250 = 1.2 days.

Days a crew needs for the whole job = 3,000 ÷ its speed: excavation about 14, pipe about 17, backfill 12.